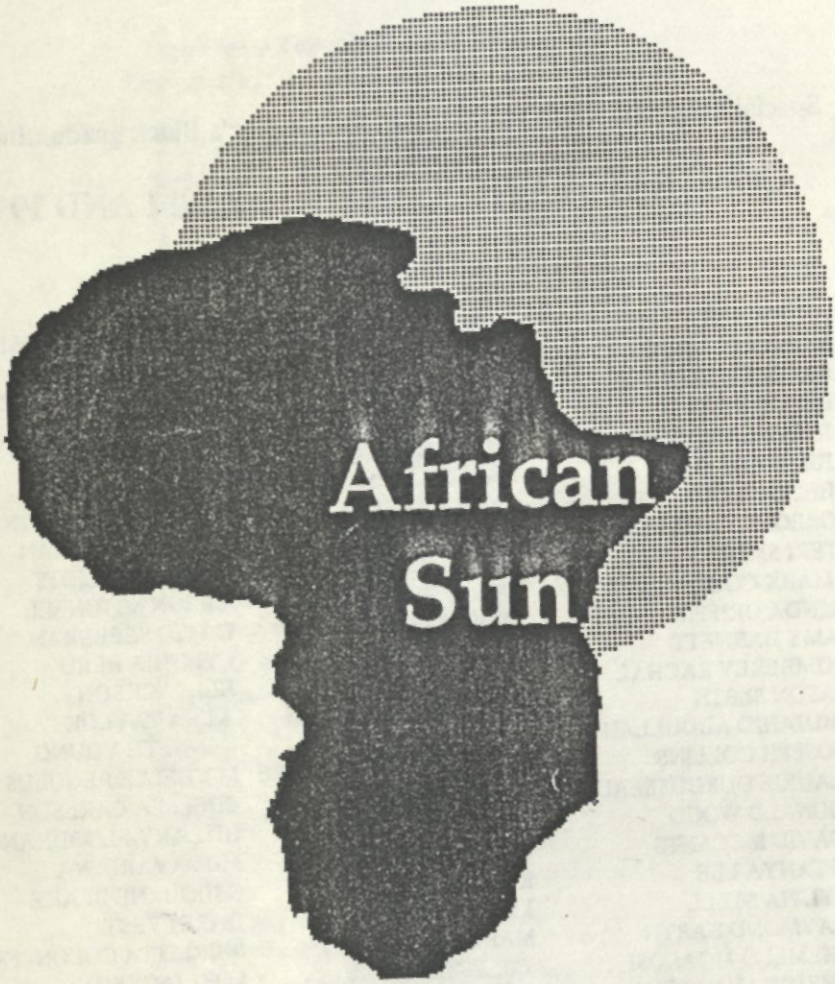

NADIRAH I MORELAND
BOX 3874

CAMPUS

To my SS, you did a great job. Love SSMB

May 1991

Special congratulations and farewell to this year's Black graduating seniors

CONGRATULATIONS CLASS OF 1991 AND 1991.5

AKINWALE ADAMS
MONIQUE TURNER
RAPHAEL BROOKS
LESLIE KING
JENNIFER BOWSER
JULIE ADAMS
HELEN BYRD
GREGORY SHAVERS
TERI SMITH
MARK COOPER
LINDA GRIFFIN
AMY BARNETT
KIMBERLY RACHAL
ASON SMITH
MUJAHID ABDULLAH
JOSEPH COLLINS
LAURIE DUROUSSEAU
DONALD WOOD
DAVID MCCANTS
N'TANYA LEE
SYLVIA STELL
RAYMOND HARTH
PHEMELO MOALOSI
CHRISTIAN BYNUM
YADEY YAWAND-WOSSEN
RODNEY VINCENT
DONALD RANDOLPH
FREDERICA MILLER
DEBORAH GLUPCZYNSKI
ARYEH FISHMAN
MATTHEW MCGUIRE
TONI JORDAN
MICHAEL WALTON
ROBERT BURCH MICHAEL
TRAINA ISLA GARRAWAY
DWAYNE RAWLINGS
RAJ SINGH
RYAN ROBERSON

MACARTHUR WHITE
RAY REAGANS
LJUILLAUNA WATSON
EUGENE LAMBERT
ANDREA CHIN
HAROLD WEEKES
KYLA HARRIEL
HELENA HOLGERSON
PRUDENCE CARTER
TRACY WASHINGTON
MARK DOWNIE
SUZIE JACINTHE
HEIDI STULTZ
CORWIN ROBERTSON
JOY WHITLOW
MATTHEW MCFARLANE
SIDNEY TRANTHAM
TRONN CARSON
MARC HARRIGAN
KELLY KIMBROUGH
KERRIE THOMAS
MARC MOORE
CELESTE PAYNE
ABIGAIL BROWN
JOSEPH OSBORNE
CYNTHIA CHENDINEN
LORIANN BROWN
DAWN HARPER
CATHY MCDONALD
CHRISTOPHER GORING
PHILLIP BENNETT
MANON LAROCHE
CARLA WAHNON
MICHELLE RATCLIFF
CYNTHIA HENRY
LORINE PENDLETON
JAMES DEBARDELABEN
RAMONA THOMAS

MENNETTE DUBOSE
SCOTT GORDON
LYDIA REASONOVER
WAYMAN CALDWELL
DAVID JOHNSON
ROBERT GREENE
MALCOLM HORTON
DANIEL WIDEMAN
GERALD ELLIOTT
SIMON MITCHELL
DAVID SEEBERAN
CYNTHIA REED
JILL JACKSON
KIMA TAYLOR
KENNETH YOUNG
MICHELLE REGULUS
CHELSEA CARLSON
HILLARY FLOODRANGA
MUVAVARIRWA
OSBOURNE BLAKE
DARIN VEST
SHIRLITTA COLON- FRANCIA
LORI JACKSON
JOHN ROUGEAU
DAVID BRYANT
ANGELA KYLE
DAWNETTE EDGERTON
DENISE WRIGHT
SHAM KHALSA
CHAKA FORMAN
KEITRICE DRAKE
IAN JOHNSTON
MARVIN PANNELL
LLIWELLYN ROBINSON
NICOLE QUOW
RICHARD D'ABREU
PATRICK JOHANSSON
IVY LIVINGSTON

They Never Thought I Could Do It
Dedicated to the classes of '91 and '91.5

They never thought I could do it,
But I always believed,
I just knew in my heart,
All along,
That someday,
I would succeed.
It's not here yet,
But it's coming real soon
And then
They'll see.
They never thought I could do it,
But hey,
I've come this far,
I've overcome all the obstacles 'til now,
And that's how it's gonna stay.
They never thought I could do it,
But I'm not bitter
You understand,
Just filled by a driving need,
To someday succeed,
Because someday I'll make it
And then,
They'll know.
Yeah,
Then they'll see,
All the beauty that lies in me.
--Antoinette Blanchette, '94

Once again, congratulations! Good luck as you step out into the real world. But don't forget those of us still here and those of us yet to arrive (or not arrive). Every year several students, many of them Black, are not admitted to Brown University because their families can't fund an Ivy League education. So as you leave Brown, don't forget that there are qualified Black students who are not able to attend Brown because they can't fund the education that you were so privileged to receive. Don't forget those who were not able to stay at Brown and frame the diploma that you will soon be honored with. Don't forget....

HISTORICAL EVENTS IN MAY

--31st, 1979- Zimbabwe gains independence.

--30th, 1822- Denmark Vessey's conspiracy, one of the most intricate slave plots in recorded history involving thousands of Blacks in Charleston, S.C. and surrounding areas, was foiled by a house slave.

--22nd,1948- Claude McKay died in Chicago, Illinois. McKay was best known for his world famous poem, "If We Must Die:"

IF WE MUST DIE, LET IT NOT BE LIKE HOGS
HUNTED AND PENNED IN AN INGLORIOUS SPOT,
WHILE ROUND US BARK THE MAD AND HUNGRY DOG,
MAKING THEIR MOCK AT OUR ACCURSED LOT.
IF WE MUST DIE, O LET US NOBLY DIE,
SO THAT OUR PRECIOUS BLOOD MAY NOT BE SHED
IN VAIN; THEN EVEN THE MONSTERS WE DEFY
SHALL BE CONSTRAINED TO HONOR US THOUGH DEAD!

O KINSMEN! WE MUST MEET THE COMMON FOE!
THOUGH FAR OUTNUMBERED LET US SHOW US BRAVE,
AND FOR THEIR THOUSAND BLOWS DEAL ONE DEATHBLOW!
WHAT THOUGH BEFORE US LIES THE OPEN GRAVE?
LIKE MEN WE'LL FACE THE MURDEROUS, COWARDLY PACK,
PRESSED TO THE WALL, DYING, BUT FIGHTING BACK!

--19th, 1925- Malcolm X was born Malcolm Little in Omaha, Nebraska. On February 21, 1965, he was assassinated by Black gunmen at the Audubon Ballroom in New York City.

--18th, 1896- The Supreme Court rendered its decision in the historical case of Plessy vs. Ferguson. Its decision sanctioned "separate but equal" facilities.

--17th, 1954, fifty-eight years following the Plessy vs. Ferguson case, the Supreme Court overturned its previous decision with the Brown vs the Board of Education of Topeka, Kansas case, negating the presumption that separate facilities could still be equal.

--7th, 1946- William Hastic became the first Black governor of the Virgin Islands.

--3rd, 1845- Macon B. Allen became the first Black lawyer in the U.S.

--1st, 1991- Rickey Henderson broke Lou Brock's record for career number of stolen bases, stealing his 939th base vs. the New York Yankees while playing for the Oakland Athletics in Oakland, California.

--, 1991- commemorates the 30th anniversary of the "freedom rides" of 1961. The rides were sponsored by the Congress of Racial Equality (CORE) in order to integrate interstate busing industry. The "freedom rides" went from Washington, D.C. to Jackson, Mississippi, during which they encountered many bloody confrontations. Their brave actions prompted the Interstate Commerce Commission to desegregate interstate travel. Thanks to the "freedom riders" for their sacrifices.

THOUGHTS AND OPINIONS

Police Brutality and Harassment

The filmed beating of Rodney King on March 3, 1991 was a remarkable event. Police brutality against Black and Latino men is now all over the headlines, but the truth is that Rodney King's beating was not unique. Similar Police beatings of Black and Latino males happen all the time. The reason this one was so special is because someone happened to film it. Now the media wants to bring attention to the problem of Police brutality, which is good but goodness, it's about time. In 1990, forty-one persons died while in police custody. Only two cops have ever been convicted of murdering a victim while under police custody. EVER! Only two per cent of Police Officers involved in brutality cases are ever convicted. These are unreal statistics. Let's not even mention police harassment because this is a way of life for Black and Latino persons. And clearly it crosses class lines. It doesn't matter if you are a student from Brown University, a high school drop out, a drug dealer or a movie star; if you are a Black person you regularly subjected to special treatment by those who are expected to "protect and to serve." Talk to Hope Bannister, Terrence Taylor, or Ray Regans, and they can tell you about the special treatment they received from our very own Brown University Police. Wesley Snipes recently called a press conference to inform the press of the special treatment accorded to him by the LAPD. While driving in Los Angeles, Snipes was stopped by Los Angeles Police officers who made him get out of his car and lay face down on the street with guns pointed at his head. Once, the officers discovered his identity, they apologized and allowed him to leave. The LAPD claims that a computer had registered Snipes' car as stolen. Since when does verifying a stolen-car claim require having the driver of the car in question lie face down with guns pointed at his head?

--Nadirah Moreland, '94

Race and the Death Penalty

The race of a defendant plays a significant role in his sentencing in capital punishment related cases. Current data proves that murderers of whites are four times more likely to receive the death penalty ~~Blacks~~ than murderers of Blacks. And while Blacks constitute 12% of the U.S. population, we comprise 50% of all death row inmates - "Death row, what a brother know". Since the reinstatement of the death penalty in 1976, there have been 144 executions. Out of all these executions, not one white person has been executed for killing a Black person. In those 144 killings, 86% of the victims were white, however, roughly half of the murder victims in the U.S. are Black people. Of the 16,000 executions in U.S. history, only thirty cases have involved a white person actually sentenced for killing a Black individual. Of course this data does not include the innumerable unprosecuted lynchings which made the lyrics of Billie Holiday's "Strange Fruit" so chillingly haunting.

Two murder cases in Columbus, Georgia further illustrate the significance of race in death penalty related cases. In February of this year, a white and a Black man

were convicted of murder in two separate cases. Robert Caldwell, a white male, was found guilty of raping and murdering his 12-year-old daughter and repeatedly stabbing his 10-year-old son. He was sentenced to life imprisonment. On the other hand, Jerry Walker, a Black man, was convicted of murdering the 22-year-old son of an Army commander at nearby Fort Benning during a convenience store robbery. His sentence was death. I am not condoning murder by either Blacks or whites, but it is worrisome that Caldwell (who raped and killed his daughter, as well as repeatedly stabbed his son) was sentenced to life imprisonment, while Walker was sentenced to be executed. It is interesting to note that the four judges in Georgia's Superior Court which tries the state's capital punishment cases are white. Furthermore, the juries in these cases are often all white, despite the fact that Blacks make up 35% of Columbus' population. Apparently, it's a matter of race!

--Terrence Taylor, '93

The Loss of the Only Third World Financial Aid Officer

The Third World Community, and especially the Black community, has lost our only representative in the Financial Aid Office. For many of us who heavily (or marginally) depend on financial aid, Walter Harper was our saviour. Without him many of us would not have come to Brown and those of us who matriculated could not have remained. How many of us related extenuating family financial situations, which either delayed or threatened to terminate payments to Walter and were relieved to see him go the extra mile to "work something out" for us and our families? How many times did we reassure our parents that if they spoke to Walter, he would do his best to alleviate their tuition-related financial worries? How many of us, who were forgetful, received a personal call from Walter alerting us of rapidly approaching financial aid related deadlines? How many of us were told by other students of color, and white students whom Walter worked with, that if we had ongoing problems with the Financial Aid Office we should see Walter Harper? How many of us told other students to see Walter if they were having problems with the Financial Aid Office? For those of us who did any or all of these things, Walter was one of the intagible elements that made an otherwise difficult Brown experience relatively amicable. He was a personable, sincere, caring person who was sensitive to our financial as well as personal situations. He took the time to meet with us outside of his office hours, and even on weekends, to completely answer our questions about financial aid and future financial aid packages.

Fortunately, for us Walter will remain at Brown. While we must thank President Gregorian for supporting Walter by reassigning him, we must also express our concerns that Walter's position be filled by someone of comparable qualifications and skills. Bluntly, we must let the President know that we want a qualified person of color who is sensitive to students' needs to replace Walter. We must also strongly express our concerns about the attrition rate of Third World administrators and faculty this past year (See section on FAREWELL TO BLACK FACULTY). Again, it is our responsibility to try to influence the selection of their replacement and avidly advocate that they be replaced by qualified people of color.

--Terrence Taylor, '93

Innocent Until Proven Guilty!

Recently, Assistant Track Coach "Skip" Miller was charged with first degree sexual assualt, rape, of a member of the 1990 Women's track team. The ensuing articles dealing with his subsequent arrest and bail hearing, in the Providence Journal and the BDH, have pronounced him guilty. The respective articles divulged both his home addresses and a picture of him, a blown up picture in the case of the BDH. While giving a defendant's name, his/her address, and showing his picture might be standard newspaper reporting procedure, this procedure needs to be questioned. First, by disseminating this type of information the newpapers give their readers the impression that the defendant is guilty. Second, they endanger the family members of the defendant and the defendant. Since Coach Miller has yet to be proven guilty, why give his address to the public and endanger his family? Does the Providence Journal plan on protecting him until his arraignment? We don't think so.

A recent incident involving allegations of sexual assault demonstrates the dangers of presuming a defendant guilty without all the facts. A white graduate of Ohio State University alleged that a Black student had raped her. The ensuing tension from her case led to altercations between Black students and campus police and a series of racial confrontations. The woman later recanted her story. This incident just shows that until all allegations are completely investigated no one, save the accused and the accuser, know all the FACTS!

As a result, we would encourage all of you to think about that and not to pass judgement. Not to belittle an alleged victim's accusations, but as in the first Scottsboro trial in Scottsboro, Alabama, shabby testimony and lack of sufficient evidence to convict "beyond a reasonable doubt," did not save nine youths from being convicted of raping two white women. In the novel, To Kill a Mockingbird, a Black man, Tom Robinson, was convicted of sexual assault that he clearly did not commit. Although it was a fictional tale, his ending has occured several times in and out of courtrooms throughout the history of this nation. This is the kind of power that white women have historically had over Black men. We are not proclaiming the innocence, guilt or veracity of the parties involved, but we, especially as Black people, can not sit by and pass judgement on our own when there are only two people that really know what occurred. We only know what we read and what we hear from the grapevine. Remember, **Innocent until proven guilty**, and not the other way around.

--Nadirah Moreland, '94 and Terrence Taylor, '93

I want to address the recent timing (or lack there of) of the law enforcement and judicial systems of this nation. A Black Ohio mayor recently was issued a subpoena during the middle of the National Conference of Black Mayors' annual meeting. The subpoena was in reference to his scheduled testimony before a grand jury which is probing real estate investments he made eight years ago. Why is it that a subpoena of an eight-month-old investigation of eight-year-old events comes up in the midst of this lawyer's high moment of attention?

With other cases, the systems are very quick to act, showing just how much race and political power of an alleged offender or alleged victim have to do with the actions of the systems. When Charles Stuart's wife was recently murdered in Boston, the city went into an uproar looking for an imaginary Black murderer which Mr. Stuart had fabricated. When evidence started pointed toward Mr. Stuart, he all of a sudden commited suicide. On the other hand, how many persons in the Kennedy family have been arrested for sexual assault? Do you think any of them will be arrested? Nope, neither do I.

--Nadirah Moreland, '94

FAREWELL TO BLACK FACULTY

We would also like to extend our congratulations and farewell to three Black faculty members who won't be returning next fall.

- Dr. Wayne Bowen, an eight year Associate Professor of Biology at Brown, will be leaving Brown to become the Chief of Unit on Receptor Biochemistry and Pharmacology in theLaboratory of Medicinal Chemistry in the National Institute for Diabetes and Digestive Kidney Diseases in Bethesda, Maryland.
- Rice Maximin Michelin, French Department
- Carol Simpkins, Associate Director of Health Services, after three years at Brown, will be leaving to assume the position of Director of Health Services at Syracuse University.

ANNOUNCEMENTS/OTHER

The Organization of United African Peoples would like to thank all those who participated in the Umoja Barbecue with a special thanks to all the organizations that contributed to the event. We thought it was successful and are considering making it an annual event. Just for clarification, "Umoja" is a Kiswahli word meaning "Unity." The OUAP looks forward to a much more successful year next year and as an umbrella organization representing all Black students on campus, we look forward to your participation.

For all those interested, the *African Sun* is a publication for the expressions of all Black students and organizations. You are encouraged to publish essays, poems, announcements, opinions, or what have you dealing with the Black community here at Brown or in the world.

Rites and Reasons theater is currently showing "The Disappearance", a stage reading by Rosa Guy. It is being directed by Ruby Dee and Elmo Terry-Morgan. It opens Friday, May 10th at 8:00 p.m. and will run until May 26th. Fridays and Saturdays the show begins at 8:00 p.m. and Sundays it begins at 4 p.m., the exception being Sunday, the 26th at 1 p.m.

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To Kill a Mokingbird, Harper Lee, 1960

CONTRIBUTORS

John Harisson, Cover

Malcolm Horton, Layout Design

Antoinette Blanchette, Dedication to Seniors

Melanie Blackless, Co-editor

Nadirah Moreland, Co-editor & Text

Neneh Mbye, "Freedom Riders"

Terrence Taylor, Co-editor & Text